Antyodaya scheme of service to the poorest of the poor is said by the government to have been inspired by him. The 'Make in India' scheme is dedicated to him, or more precisely, 'laid at his feet'.[38] The Mughalserai railway station, where he died in mysterious circumstances at the age of fifty-two, has been renamed for him. The Deen Dayal Research Institute is reportedly 'a hub of frenetic activity', drowning under a 'flood of queries from government departments' trying to learn about Upadhyaya's ideas, which are now expected to animate their work.[39]

Upadhyaya's writings and speeches on the principles and policies of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh, his philosophy of 'Integral Humanism' and his vision for the rise of modern India, constitute the most comprehensive articulation of what might be described as a BJP ideology. The reverence in which he is held by those in power today and the near-deification of the man give him an intellectual status within the Hindutva movement second to none.

Upadhyaya saw his own thinking as flowing from that of Guru Golwalkar, the Sarsanghchalak of the RSS with whom he worked most closely. Golwalkar, in turn, was inspired by Vinayak ('Veer') Savarkar's ideology of Hindutva. But whereas Golwalkar, with his desire to learn from Nazi practices, was judged too extreme for most mainstream opinion, Upadhyaya, who couched his ideas in moderate language, enjoyed broader acceptability. Unlike many ideologues, Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya was not just a theorist, but the leader of a growing political party and also its principal organiser. This created a curious paradox. As a political leader, it was imperative for him to respond to the day-to-day problems facing the party, critique government policies, issue and direct party propaganda, lead agitations, evolve the party's electoral strategy and negotiate coalitions. His philosophy was thus the animating spirit of a life of practical action. Upadhyaya's political role and values thus emerged from his philosophy, and the latter justified the former.

At the same time, the Jana Sangh of Upadhyaya's day was not a realistic contender for power. Upadhyaya thus saw himself in the longer term as a thinker whose role was, as one admirer put it, to project genuine nationalistic thought in the political sphere, well beyond the limited and short-term aim of the attainment of political office. One